

Nan Processed Agriculture Cluster · Mueang Nan · Nan Province

Many producers, one local identity — adding value to Nan's wisdom

Background

Nan is a mountainous headwater province in Thailand's upper north. Its villages hold a wealth of local raw materials: *mafai jin* (Chinese wampee), *mak khwaen* (Sichuan pepper), golden oranges, peanuts, honey, herbs, highland coffee — and the know-how to process them. Yet small community enterprises working alone struggle with the same barriers: brands too small to be noticed, costly marketing and logistics, and standards that are hard to meet.

OrigiNan, the Origin of Nan, grew from a simple conviction shared by local processors: **a business on its own cannot go as far as a network**. Many of its members belong to a new generation of entrepreneurs who chose to return home and give Nan's resources creative value. OrigiNan is the **processed agriculture cluster** of Nan Province — 66 member communities and groups in 10 of the province's 15 districts — and the **umbrella brand** under which members develop and sell products made only from Nan raw materials. Its home is the **Origi-nan Space** at Ban Thua Lisong, near Nan airport.

The cluster is one of seven economic clusters recognised by Nan Province (tourism, community spirits, herbal medicine, processed agriculture, handwoven textiles, silverware and large-scale farming). Its work gained new resonance in 2025, when Nan was designated a **UNESCO Creative City of Crafts and Folk Art**.

Origins of OrigiNan

From processors to a cluster

In 2017 (B.E. 2560) the Ministry of Industry was promoting business clusters across Thailand. Ms. Aree Phetrat of Ban Thua Lisong, a family peanut-processing business, attended the training and saw its value — but Nan then had clusters only for silverware and handwoven textiles, none for agriculture. Talking with fellow entrepreneurs, among them Mr. Thirayut Chankhlai, a processor of Chinese wampee and other local fruit products, they found their common ground in the midstream: processing. Seven or eight communities founded the processed agriculture cluster.

The same year it was legally registered and certified by the Nan Provincial Industry Office, with recognition from the Department of Industrial Promotion, Region 1 (Chiang Mai). Development funding followed for about five years (2018–2023): used to build the cluster's roles and working processes. Membership rose from 20 in 2017 to 77 in 2018–2020.

COVID and the turn to markets

COVID-19 cut public budgets and stopped travel — and sales. Before the pandemic the cluster had concentrated on product development; afterwards it understood that **online markets, storytelling, content and digital tools** were essential. When funding resumed in 2022, the cluster increasingly raised its own resources through pitching competitions and university partnerships.

A shared brand

To give members' diverse products a common face, the cluster created the OrigiNan brand: products must be made from Nan raw materials and carry the province's identity. Its signature ingredient is Nan's GI-registered golden orange (*som si thong*), worked into essential oil, jam, cookies, liqueur and cosmetics. When a Thai Senate delegation visited in 2023, the cluster was cited as a model of regional cluster development, and in 2024 OrigiNan received an Outstanding Innovation Award.

TIMELINE SUMMARY

2017	2018–20	2020–22	2023	2024	2025
Cluster founded by 7 community enterprises and certified.	Public development funding; membership peaks at 77.	COVID: budgets cut; shift to online markets and content.	OrigiNan brand built around the GI golden orange.	Origi-nan Space opens; Outstanding Innovation Award.	New vision and missions; Nan named UNESCO Creative City.

How the Cluster Works

Five missions

1. Carry Nan's local wisdom forward with **technology and innovation** to create added value.
2. Promote the **creative economy and BCG** (Bio-Circular-Green) principles among members.
3. Run a **mutually supportive business** sharing knowledge and raw materials rather than competing.
4. Foster **new businesses and grow existing ones**: the OrigiNan brand and members' own brands coexist.
5. Become a **business academy and service centre**, earning income from members' workshops, not just products.

Governance on a shoestring

Mr. Thirayut Chankhlai chairs the cluster; Ms. Aree Phetrat is its Cluster Development Agent (CDA), who carries the vision across changes of leadership. The cluster has no full-time staff: members take turns handling meetings, visits and interviews for a small allowance (200 baht per task). Members pay a 700-baht annual fee, and 3% of OrigiNan-brand sales goes to a central fund for management costs. The Provincial Commerce Office acts as the cluster's government mentor.

Growing members step by step

New members first register their products, raw materials, standards and production capacity in the cluster database. They then enter a learning process: rather than marketing for them, the cluster teaches members to sell — storytelling, content, packaging design, pricing, offline and online marketing. Products that are ready in packaging, price and volume go straight to market, and their success motivates others.

A COMMON VISION

To elevate Nan's local wisdom together with fellow entrepreneurs through the creative economy, and to be a model of mutually supportive business for the pride of the people of Nan.

Members, Products and Markets

66	390	240 t+	1,500+
member communities & groups	people, in 10 of 15 districts	Nan raw materials used per year	visitors & workshop learners

1 · Agricultural produce
raw materials & processed crops: peanuts, Chinese wampee, mak khwaen, oranges

2 · Local wisdom & culture
crafts and products rooted in Nan's heritage, e.g. natural tie-dye

ORIGI Nan

3 · Farm & tourism products
honey, salt and other farm goods; e.g. Luk Chan PGS Nan

4 · Health & well-being
herbal inhalers, shampoos, Nan herbs; e.g. Bio-way, Baan Nam Kian

OrigiNan's four member categories, with examples

Developing the OrigiNan brand

Each year, members pitch new OrigiNan products; only members with the required standards and experience are selected, and grants cover the development period only, afterwards the maker produces at their own cost. Funding has come from the Nan Provincial Administrative Organization (year 1), an NIA pitching programme (year 2) and the Regional Industrial Promotion Center 1 (year 3). Universities fund specific lines: orange jam and other foods with RMUTL Nan; shampoo, lip balm and face foam with Uttaradit Rajabhat University. The 2024 line added grain products, orange cookies, orange liqueur and banana chips with orange jam. Seasonal limited editions showcase Nan's diversity, such as the Nan Honey box set of seven wild honeys from seven botanical sources across the province.

Partners

The cluster gathers members' needs and then brings in the agency best placed to meet them. Partners include the Nan Provincial Industry, Agriculture and Commerce Offices; the Nan PAO; NIA; universities (RMUTL Nan, Uttaradit Rajabhat) and science parks in Phayao, Uttaradit, Chiang Mai and Chiang Rai. Cooperation depends on each agency's budget and objectives.

Shared markets and logistics

OrigiNan sells B2B and B2C, online and offline, across Thailand, including through the Chaipattana Foundation shop, with export as a long-term goal. Ban Thua Lisong runs the community service centre: a **live-streaming room**, a **community warehouse** and **storefronts** on Shopee, Lazada and LINE OA. Members can sell in the shop or online; when an order comes in, Ban Thua Lisong **packs and ships** it so that members can focus on production. Members also share raw materials with one another.

A local business academy

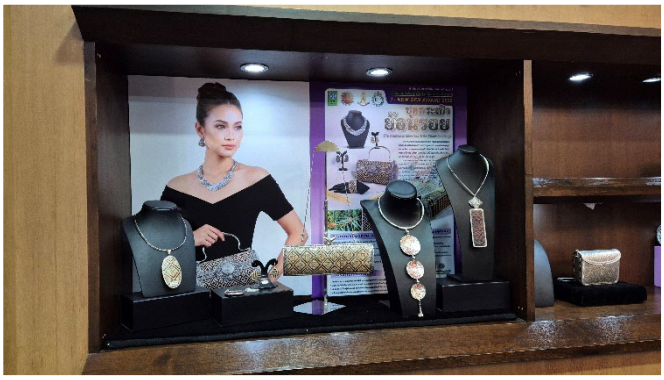
Workshops are a growing income stream for members, who design and teach them. Each workshop lasts about 40 minutes, and every participant takes home what they made. Schools choose from the list of members-proposed workshops according to their goals. More than 1,500 people have visited or trained at OrigiNan — students, and also groups such as 100-plus housewives from Wang Thonglang in Bangkok, who went home able to make and sell products themselves.

Opened in June 2024 beside Ban Thua Lisong on Route 101, the Space combines a gallery telling the cluster's story, a Nan coffee and peanut-milk bar, a craft corner, and meeting rooms for 60 and 10 people.





Promoting a large diversity of members' activities

















Origi-nan Space, Route 101, near Nan Nakhon Airport, 113 Moo 2, Pha Sing Sub-district, Mueang Nan District, Nan Province, Thailand

Hours Daily · shop 08:30–17:30 · Origi-nan Space 09:30–16:30

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